1958 was India's Ambassador to Washington. Parekh also enjoyed an excellent reputation, but among a much smaller circle of businessmen. But Mehta, though nominally a 'part-time' Director, had been given 'executive powers'. This made the government uneasy because it could be seen as a violation of the Companies Act, under which the General Manager had 'powers of management'. ICICI therefore had to give formal assurances that Mehta was only 'part-time' Chairman and that the 'executive powers' given him 'do not include any powers of management', which belonged to a 'full time' Managing Director. William Diamond who had been assigned by the World Bank to work with ICICI, observed that in this ambiguous situation, there was plenty of room for conflict.[2]

Diamond observed, 'It was ICICI's good fortune that the conflict never developed, thanks to the personalities and intelligence of both Mehta and Parekh. They were deeply interested in the mission of ICICI and they had the wit to see quickly that they complemented each other. Mehta was outgoing, vivacious, knew his way in both the political and bureaucratic power structures, and was first class in public relations. But he knew he lacked the deep company knowledge and financial expertise that Parekh had. Parekh was quiet and introverted, did little (I think) spontaneously. I took a photo of Mehta clowning in my flat in Bombay while wearing a fur hat that I had just made in preparation for visiting Russia. I cannot imagine Parekh evoking a laugh that way, let alone allowing it to be recorded.'[3]

Mehta and Parekh recognized that they complemented each other, and got on well together. But there was no doubt that Mehta was the boss. While Mehta did participate in all decision-making, he focused primarily on external matters—Board relations, the government, foreign leaders, the media, and links with the business organizations and power structure. Parekh concentrated on managing ICICI on a day-to-day basis: investments, administration, and the like. Both took individual initiatives on matters of policy and recruitment, but all important decisions were taken by consensus. It took a little while, but not too long, to develop this cordial and productive relationship. It also resulted in ICICI becoming and being perceived as less elitist in its approach.

As Parekh wrote in *Swayam*, the house journal of ICICI, 'In 1958, Shri Gaganvihari Mehta became Chairman of ICICI and I became General Manager. ICICI's management techniques also changed. With the new